Assessment Task 3 – Marking Criteria

Assess the impact of influences on operations.

Criteria	Marks
• Makes a well-reasoned judgment (of value, quality, outcomes or results) of the impact of influences on operations • Applies relevant case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Presents a sustained, logical and cohesive response and communicates clearly using relevant business terminology and concepts	17–20
• Makes some judgment about the relationship between influences and the impact on operations • Uses relevant case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Presents a logical and cohesive response using relevant terminology and concepts	13–16
• Provides characteristics and features of influences and their possible impact on operations • May make reference to case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Communicates using business terminology and concepts	9–12
• Sketches in general terms influences on operations • May make reference to case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Communicates using some business terminology and concepts	5–8
• Makes limited references to influences on operations • May identify case study/studies • Uses basic business terminology	1–4

Answers may include:

Influences:

- Globalisation
- Technology
- Quality expectations
- Cost-based competition
- Government policies
- Legal regulation
- Environmental sustainability
- CSR – social responsibility,

Impact on Operations

Students need to assess the impact of these influences and may include their impact on:

- Inputs in the operations process
- Aspects of the transformation process
- Outputs in the operations process

Operations Strategies such as:

- performance objectives – quality, speed, dependability, flexibility, customisation, cost
- new product or service design and development
- supply chain management – logistics, e-commerce, global sourcing
- outsourcing – advantages and disadvantages
- technology – leading edge, established
- inventory management – advantages and disadvantages of holding stock, LIFO (last-in-first-out), FIFO (first-in-first-out), JIT (just-in-time)
- quality management
- control
- assurance
- improvement
- overcoming resistance to change – financial costs, purchasing new equipment, redundancy

payments, retraining, reorganising plant layout, inertia

- global factors – global sourcing, economies of scale, scanning and learning, research and development